

Penile Plication

WARWIKI

Patient Information · Surgery to straighten the penis (Peyronie's disease)

In Peyronie's disease, a scar (plaque) inside the penis can make it bend during an erection. This can make sex hard. Penile plication straightens the bend. The surgeon places stitches on the longer side of the penis to tuck it, so it matches the shorter side.

About This Procedure

The scar pulls one side of the penis tighter, so it bends. Plication shortens the **longer (outer) side** of the curve with stitches until both sides match. No scar is cut and no graft is used. It is the simplest straightening operation, and it has a lower risk of new erection problems than grafting.

It is a good choice when:

- Your curve is moderate and not complex
- Your **erections are good**, with or without help from pills
- You accept that the penis will be somewhat shorter

Benefits and Risks in Numbers

9 in 10

men get a straight erection

up to
1 in 10

get new or worse erection problems

5–12 in 100

lose enough length that it affects sex

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

What to Know

- **Shortening:** the penis usually measures less than 1 cm shorter, but it can be up to about 2–2.5 cm. Many men feel it is shorter than it measures. Your team may measure your length before surgery.
- **Stitches:** you may feel them under the skin. Most men are not bothered by them.
- **The goal** is a penis straight enough for comfortable sex. It may not be perfectly straight, and the curve can come back.

Learn the Terms

Peyronie's disease

A scar in the penis that makes it bend during an erection.

Plaque

The patch of scar tissue that causes the curve.

Plication

Straightening the penis by stitching and shortening the longer side.

Artificial erection

An erection made with an injection during surgery, so the surgeon can see the curve.

Circumcision

Removal of the foreskin. It is sometimes done at the same time.

Vacuum device

A tube and pump that some teams use during healing to help keep length.

Will it hurt? You will be asleep or numb during surgery, so you feel nothing. Afterward, expect swelling, bruising and soreness of the penis for 1–2 weeks. Ice, snug underwear and pain medicine help. Most men go home the same day or the next morning.

Next day If you have a catheter, it usually comes out.	Weeks 1–2 Swelling and bruising settle. Keep the area clean.	Weeks 1–6 No sex while the stitches heal.	Weeks 6–8 Sex again once your team checks that you have healed.
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How to Get Ready

- Your Peyronie's should be **stable** first: the curve has not changed for at least 3 months.
- Follow your surgery instructions about eating, drinking and which medicines to stop, including blood thinners.
- Stop smoking. Any infection is treated first.

Tell your team ahead of time if you:

- Have **weak erections** or take medicine for erections
- Take a blood thinner, or have had penile surgery before

What Happens During Surgery

- 1 You receive anesthesia and antibiotics.
- 2 An injection makes an **erection** so the surgeon can see the curve. Stitches are placed on the longer side.
- 3 Another erection checks the result. The skin is closed.

Some teams have you take a low-dose erection pill or use a vacuum device during healing. Your team will tell you.

Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Redness, pain or fluid from the cut that is getting worse
- A “pop” during an erection, and the curve comes back

Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate
- Bleeding will not stop, or swelling grows fast
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

Three Things to Remember

1. Plication straightens the penis with stitches. No scar is cut.
2. Expect some shortening. About 9 in 10 men get a straight erection.
3. No sex until your team says you have healed, often 6–8 weeks.